

vision extends beyond the camera itself; it is a synergy of hardware, lenses, and software stacks working cohesively to deliver meaningful outcomes.

Last year, a major industry player invested about a hundred million dollars in your company. Where are you utilising this funding?

Currently, we are utilising this funding to develop our technology in three distinct areas. First and foremost, we are using it to enhance our research and development (R&D) efforts and expanding our imaging labs. Additionally, we are strategically expanding our business. This includes setting up offices in the United States, a major market for us. This expansion signifies our commitment to reaching new heights in the industry and further establishing our presence in key markets.

From chips, we have advanced to chiplets. Semiconductor technology is increasingly becoming more application-specific and miniaturising. Do you think existing chip design technologies will be able to keep pace with this evolution or will we see a complete reversal in chip design?

The evolution of semiconductor technology beyond Moore's Law is inevitable, and the landscape is definitely changing. Initially, general-purpose chipsets dominated, serving various functions, followed by network processors designed around microprocessor cores, to cater to the growing telecom domain. With the rise of mobile phones, specialised chips integrated GSM and other functionalities. Currently, we witness a trend where there are both general-purpose AI chips, exemplified by companies like NVIDIA and Qualcomm, capable of running multiple AI models,

and application-specific AI chips, designed for specific tasks such as face recognition or agriculture-related applications. The expectation is that smaller, specialised chips will consume less power and execute specific tasks efficiently. While larger, general-purpose AI chips are versatile, the demand for more tailored solutions is evident. Numerous startups are actively developing such specialised chips, emphasising the growing importance of application-specific solutions.



What does this mean for companies such as e-con Systems?

At e-con, our focus is on collaborating with chipset makers and sensor manufacturers to create comprehensive solutions. We experiment with chipsets and AI scales to find optimal combinations for customer solutions at competitive prices. While the primary target market is the United States due to its abundance of hardware startups, we're open to collaborating in India and seek innovative partnerships. We would love to partner with Indian companies developing groundbreaking products, such as security cameras with indigenous designs and algorithms tailored for Indian conditions. Our vision includes creating fully designed and manufactured Indian-branded cameras to promote local innovation

and contribute to global hardware ecosystem growth.

With the increasing focus on establishing a local component manufacturing ecosystem, how does the quality of the component sector in India compare to the one outside India?

The 'Make in India' initiative has brought the focus towards a self-reliant ecosystem, but the goal is not just to be satisfied with the current progress but to continually push for further expansion and development. The key lies not only in manufacturing locally but also in designing, developing, and creating intellectual property (IP) within India, allowing local players to contribute to the entire product lifecycle, from ideation to manufacturing, and sell globally, so that the intellectual property stays within the country, providing control and ownership.

As manufacturing gains momentum, it becomes a sustained process, encouraging a focus on cost optimisation and efficiency. This, in turn, paves the way for more companies to generate IP locally and manufacture products within the country. We need to maintain this momentum for continuous growth. As the manufacturing ecosystem strengthens, more companies will become part of the value chain, potentially specialising in specific components or sourcing materials locally.

How has the local component supply chain for e-con evolved in the past 20 years and where do you see this sector heading?

The supply chain import processes have improved drastically in the last 20 years, aided by new laws. We are in a very good phase. Overall, we are witnessing substantial growth in electronics